

Android keyboard alternatives

Hate your phone's built-in keyboard app?

Replace it with one of these fine gems

<http://dgit.in/1r3kkRd>

Chrome runs faster

If you're an Android user, here's a nice little hack that can make your Chrome experience even better

<http://dgit.in/S3eU8S>

Android Phones



Samsung Galaxy S5

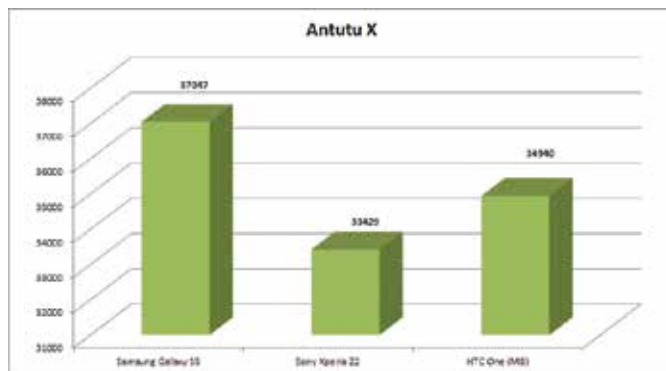
3 and the back is again low-grade plastic. Thankfully, there is a new, perforated pattern on the back panel. The back also houses a new 16MP camera and a heart-rate monitor. Under the back panel we find a microSD card slot, a microSIM card slot and the 2600mAh battery. The back panel also has a rubber lining on the inside to give some protection against water and dust. The most hyped feature, the finger-print scanner has been incorporated into the physical home button.

Sony has been producing some of the best looking smartphones in its Xperia range and the Z2 is a fine example. The Z1 was an excellent looking smartphone and with the Z2, things get better. The Z2 offers the same dimensions and design as the Z1 with the front and back glass panels and metal frame in the middle. Sony has managed to reduce the bezels further and increased the display size to 5.2 inches. The display is also a brand new IPS panel which offers much better viewing angles than the Z1. Sony has also dropped the idea of fitting an in-house screen protector which, we think, isn't a bad idea. The most crucial update in the design is the reworked loudspeakers. The Z2 has

stereo speakers on either side of the display and now offers much better volume. The ports are again covered with plastic flaps but this time they feel much stronger. Overall the Z2 gives off a premium smartphone vibe but the only issue one might face is the glass finish which leads to a lot of glare and of course the horror of getting scratched easily.

HTC has always focused on classy looking smartphones. Last year the HTC One was the best looking Android smartphone and this year, the HTC One (M8) does it again. The elegant metal design and detail is worth the money. HTC claims that the new handset consists about 80% of metal and the rest is plastic and glass. The One (M8) sports a 5-inch, full HD Super LCD3 screen which is a considerable bump from the last year's 4.7-inch display. The capacitive Android navigation keys have been replaced with on-screen ones, giving more room for the display. The touchscreen is very fluid and the response time is quick and smoother than most of the smartphones we've tested. The back has a brushed metal finish and houses the dual-lens camera with a dual-tone LED flash. There is also a laser engraved HTC logo which adds to the oomph factor to the smartphone. Maybe the only let-down is that the smartphone does not offer dust and water resistance. Also, having a metal body means that it's prone to minor scuffs and bumps.

It's a strong fight between the Xperia Z2 and the One (M8). While the Z2 offers a snazzy looking glass finish and environmental resistance, the One offers you the elegance of an all



The Galaxy S5 is the obvious winner here.

metal body and droolworthy styling to die for.

Hardware and Performance

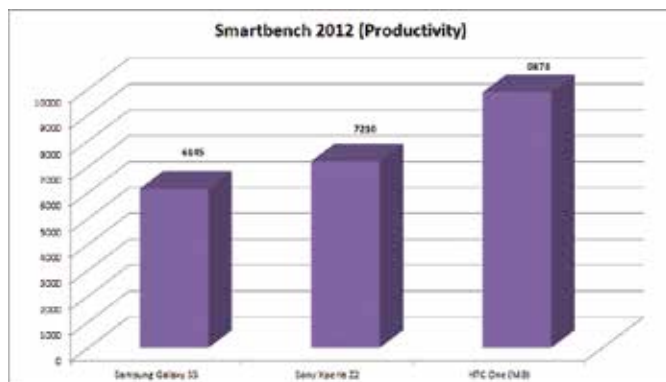
The Samsung Galaxy S5 runs on an octa-core Exynos 5 chip coupled with 2GB of RAM and a Mali-T628 MP6 GPU. The other two run on the new Snapdragon 801 processor with the same Adreno 330 GPU but the Z2 carries 3GB of RAM while the One (M8) has 2GB. To test out the performance level of the hardware we carried out some benchmark tests to get some figures for comparison. We ran benchmark apps like 3DMark, Antutu X, Quadrant Standard and Smartbench 2012 and here are the results:

The HTC One (M8) does get a higher score, but in day to day performance, all the three smartphones provide a flawless performance package.

Graphics intensive tasks like gaming and playing HD videos were a piece of cake for all three smartphones.

Everyday tasks like internet browsing, checking emails, social media update, reading news, listening to music or just watching movies was equally good on all the handsets. The OS is very stable on the three smartphones but if we're truly brutal, then the Z2 and One (M8) offer a slightly better performance experience than the Galaxy S5.

Comparing the displays, it's Super AMOLED against IPS LCD against Super LCD3. The resolution of the display is the same on all three but due to the different sizes there is a slight difference in the pixel density. The Galaxy has a 5.1 inch display which means 432ppi, the Xperia Z2 has a 5.2 inch display (424ppi) and the One (M8) has a 5 inch display leading to the



And the HTC One (M8) takes the cake here